

The Noble Six-Syllable Wisdom Mantra

Ārya-ṣaḍakṣara-vidyā · Toh 575 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་ཡི་གེ་དབྱེ་པའི་རིག་སྒྲུང་།

Toh 575 in the Kangyur is a short dhāraṇī scripture known in Sanskrit as the Ārya-ṣaḍakṣara-vidyā and in Tibetan as Phags pa yi ge drug pa'i rig sngags, meaning in English the Noble Six-Syllable Wisdom Mantra. It belongs to the class of canonical dhāraṇī texts and concerns a powerful six-syllable mantra said to have been proclaimed by six fully awakened buddhas, the four world-guardian kings, and twenty-eight great yakṣa commanders, and which the Buddha instructs his disciple Ānanda to hold, recite, master, and perfect. The text is framed as a discourse delivered by the Blessed One at Śrāvastī and follows the conventional sūtra opening, presenting the mantra together with its lineage of transmission and implicit merit. Translated into Tibetan by the Śes-sde translation team, it forms part of the dhāraṇī section of the Kangyur.

Translated, edited, and finalized by the Śes-sde translation team.

In the language of India: Ārya-ṣaḍakṣara-vidyā. In the Tibetan language: The Noble Six-Syllable Wisdom Mantra.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time, the Blessed One was dwelling at Śrāvastī. Then the Blessed One declared to the Venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, the Six-Syllable Wisdom Mantra, which was proclaimed by six perfectly and completely awakened buddhas, by the four guardians of the world, and by the twenty-eight great yakṣa commanders — this Queen of the Six-Syllable Wisdom Mantras, Ānanda, you must hold, recite, master, and make fully complete.

"Tadyathā: Dantile, Kantile, Daṇḍimati, Madhumati, Maraṇḍi, Koraṇḍe, Drāviti, Kośāri, Tsaṭaje, Dudumani, Ketumati, Cudundhe, Kauṭadanate, Tahurare, Enanige, Hutabahuni.

"Ānanda, this is the Six-Syllable Wisdom Mantra. From ailments of the head, ailments of the eyes, ailments of the ears, ailments of the teeth, ailments of the nose, ailments of the tongue, ailments of the heart, ailments of the belly, ailments of the back, ailments of the sides, ailments of the bladder, ailments of the shins, ailments of the feet, ailments of the limbs, ailments of the joints, indigestion, bloating, obstructions in the womb, disorders arising from wind,

disorders arising from bile, disorders arising from phlegm, disorders arising from their combination, violent fevers, one-day fevers, two-day fevers, three-day fevers, four-day fevers, intermittent fevers, daytime fevers, and fevers that strike at night — from all these, this Six-Syllable Wisdom Mantra shall protect, thoroughly shelter, completely uphold, thoroughly sustain, and bring about peace and wellbeing. Whoever would oppose what has been effected through warding off punishment, warding off weapons, neutralizing poison, driving away by water, and binding with cord — their head shall split into seven pieces, like the flower-bud of the arjaka plant. Ānanda, I have not seen in this world, with its gods, māras, and Brahmā, among the assemblies of ascetics and brahmins, among gods, humans, and asuras, anyone who could thwart this.

"Tadyathā: Aṇḍare, Paṇḍare, Karete, Keyūre, Bhūtaṃgame, Bhutagrahe, Bhutaprakṣite, Bhutayasmarayani, Priyāvanite, Javati, Yaśovati, Giriṇini, Śārīṇini — may I be well and happy from all fears and all harms. Svāhā."

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, the Venerable Ānanda, the gods —

Translator's Notes

- The text breaks off mid-sentence at the end of the passage provided, cutting off the list of those who rejoiced after the Blessed One's declaration; the translation faithfully ends where the source ends.

The mantra syllables rendered here follow the Tibetan phonetic transcription of Sanskrit as closely as possible. The underlying Sanskrit of the dhāraṇī phrases is partially recoverable but in places obscured by transmission; the phonetic rendering is consistent with standard practice for dhāraṇī texts.

The term rendered "Queen of the Six-Syllable Wisdom Mantras" treats vidyārājñī, implied by "rgyal mo," as a standard epithet for a foremost dhāraṇī. The Tibetan title "ṣaḍakṣara-vidyā" technically means "six-syllable wisdom," though the dhāraṇī as preserved is considerably longer than six syllables; this is a recognized feature of the text and not a translation error.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of

spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.